

(In PowerPoint 2007: Follow the steps we've mentioned above to get the Format Area dialog box. In this dialog, select the Fill option to choose the background colour. You can also have gradients, colours, and pictures as the background for your chart. Other options under the Format Area dialog box allow you to change Border colour, Border Style, add Shadow and 3D effects. You can choose the colour of shadow and even the angle by using the Shadow option. The 3-D Format option allows you to raise the chart from the slide, giving a 3-D effect.)

Follow the same steps to change the colour and style of a plot area.

13.7.3 Adding Gridlines

You can add gridlines to show where bars or columns meet or surpass a major unit of measurement. Finer gridlines can be used to mark less significant measurements.

- Select a gridline on the chart and right-click.
- In the Format Gridline... dialog box, under the Scale tab, edit the values to increase or decrease the frequency of major and minor gridlines. You can also select pattern lines of these gridlines from the Pattern tab under the same dialog box.

(In PowerPoint 2007, formatting gridlines is similar to how you do it in PowerPoint 2003, but through this method you will not be able change the frequency of gridlines. To change the frequency of major and minor gridlines and add horizontal gridlines (not available in the 2003 version), go to Chart Tools > Layout > Axes > Gridlines. Now select the option to add Major, Minor, Mixed from Primary Horizontal Gridlines or Primary Vertical Gridlines).